



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

8(8M)M8G\$*A*B0M5@
M09#5M >0#8M%\$M5>&M >5M/>&?7A
M0M80M/G#G
0M#B>'M/\$M5.A*0?7M >(M(?7G\$M8M/\$G
\$>5M5>0#?0M05\$M08 8M >OK
5H&M/K*&?7M 8 8M >08 8M >0M/\$M5>5'>0#>\$M

— Tantravārttika, 50th Chapter, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Tantravārttika delves into the nature of sound, specifically questioning whether the correct sequencing of sounds (anusarva) is an inherent property of words themselves or something else entirely. If the sequence were intrinsic to the word, then grammar's role as a purifier (samskaraka) of speech would be undermined. The text argues that correct sequencing arises from the act of grasping (grahana) and uttering (uccharana) the word, pointing to examples like "gavya" (related to cows), where the sequence is not inherently pure but depends on correct pronunciation.

The scripture then addresses the notion that grammar might purify the act of grasping and uttering. It anticipates and dismisses this idea, foreshadowing a later argument that an action cannot be the means of perfecting itself. This is akin to suggesting a pot can make itself! Furthermore, the text contends that grammar cannot purify the palate (talū) or auditory organs (shrotra), which are essential for speech. Instead, the purification of these organs, if needed, falls under the domain of medicine and therapeutic practices, not grammatical rules. This emphasizes that true purification extends beyond mere linguistic correctness.

In modern life, we often obsess over perfect communication, focusing on grammar and vocabulary. But the Tantravārttika reminds you that true communication goes deeper. It's not just about the correct sequence of words, but about the intention and understanding behind them. It speaks to the need to purify your inner space, your intentions, and your attentiveness before you attempt to communicate. Just as the palate and ears need proper care, so too does your mind and heart. Are you truly listening to understand, or simply waiting for your turn to speak? Are your words fueled by kindness and compassion, or by ego and judgment? Grammar can refine your speech, but it cannot transform your spirit. The scripture pushes you to seek a deeper purification, one that encompasses not just your words, but your entire being.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you prioritizing external correctness over internal purification in your communications and interactions today, and if so, how can you shift your focus?